

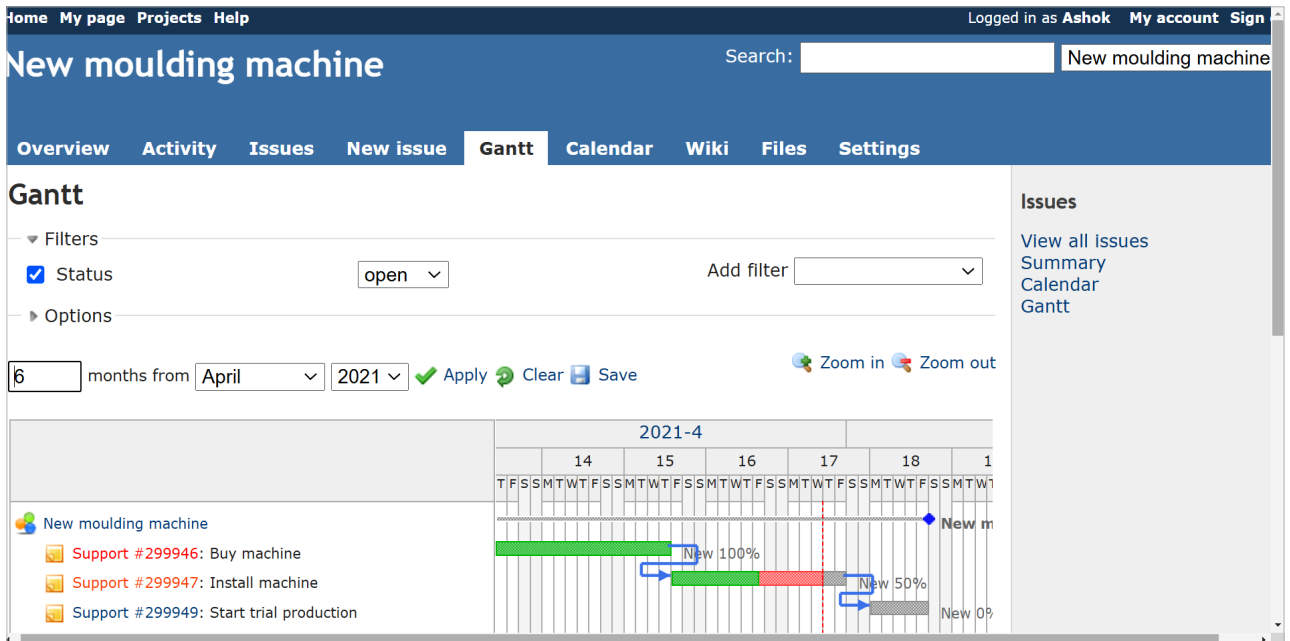


Figure 3: Redmine 3.0 Gantt chart

so that you stay in the list or form while editing. Even if you go into editing mode, there is an arrow to show you the way back to the list or form.

OpenProject CE uses the term 'work packages' for tasks. The automatic scheduling mode is generally set as the default mode for new work packages. The follower's start date is adjusted to its predecessor's finish date.

OpenProject CE supports building information modelling (BIM)

If you are in the construction industry, you can leverage this capability. OpenProject BIM includes a 3D model viewer (IFC). You can upload a 3D model of the building in industry standard IFC format. Open source CAD tools like Blender and FreeCAD have BIM add-ons that can export to this IFC format. Team members can view the model in the viewer and create issues. This helps to detect construction and design issues early in the game, preventing change orders and unforeseen conditions. Also, this can be used to estimate construction costs.

Redmine - traditional user interface

Redmine uses the term 'issues' for tasks. Click on an *Issue* to go to the page where you can edit it. But there is no easy way to get back to the list of issues. This is one of the limitations of the traditional user interface. For assigning a predecessor to an issue, you have to select the *Related Issue*. Once you select the related issue among the available ones, you can mark that as a predecessor, successor... and so on.

There are some responsive themes available. However, these are commercial and you will have to take on the technical challenges of installing and maintaining them. There are third party free (not open source) mobile apps that work with Redmine. From what I understand, Redminer for Android and RedminePM for iOS are helpful for updating the status of tasks on the go.

Forum, wiki and document upload for project team communication

One of the simple ways to improve tracking of your project is to ensure that all relevant discussions,

communications, etc, are attached to it. To make this process easier, these tools have a simple threaded forum system built in. In addition, they feature wikis where you can create project documentation. You will also be able to upload documentation for sharing with the team.

Sub-projects allow you to create summary 'at a glance' reports for the leadership of the company, combining the status of a group of related projects. In the first part of this series, we said that the open source desktop project management tools do not have the ability to create sub-projects. Fortunately, these two project servers allow you to create them.

Back up your data just in case anything goes wrong

When you have a centralised system like this, the advantage is that there is a single source of truth. Namely, there will not be any confusion among the team members as to what the status of the project is because everyone is viewing a common database. But, the risk is that you could lose this single instance of the data due to